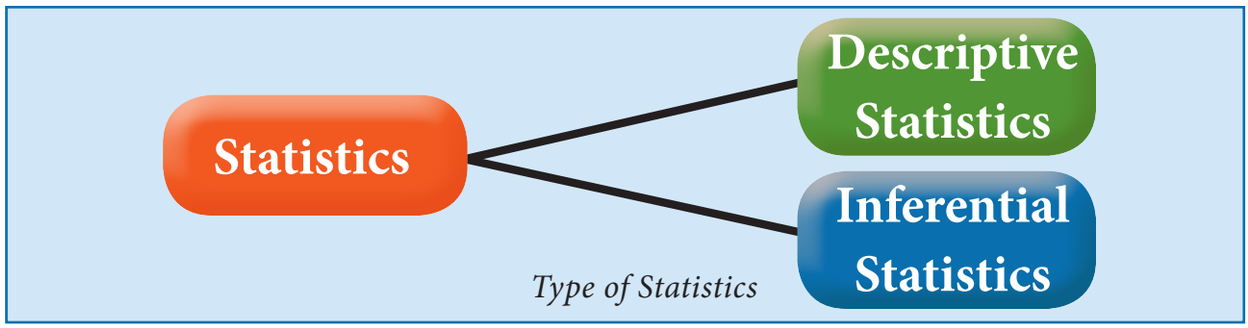


Type of Statistics

Major differences between Descriptive Statistics and Inferential Statistics

S.No	Descriptive statistics	Inferential statistics
1.	It describes the population under study.	It draws conclusion for the population based on the sample result.
2.	It presents the data in a meaningful way through charts, diagrams, graphs, other than describing in words.	It uses hypotheses, testing and predicting on the basis of the outcome.
3.	It gives the summary of data.	It tries to understand the population beyond the sample.

12.9 Data

Data are the information about facts or numbers collected to be examined and used to help with decisions. Data are the basic raw materials of statistics.

In statistics, data are classified into two broad categories: 1.Quantitative data and Qualitative data.

1. **Quantitative data** are those that can be quantified in definite units of measurement. These refer to characteristics whose successive measurements yield quantifiable observations. Eg. Age, income, number of firms etc

2. **Qualitative data** refer to qualitative characteristics of a subject or an object. A characteristic is qualitative in nature when its observations are defined and noted in terms of the presence or absence of a certain attribute in discrete numbers. These data are further classified as nominal and rank data. Eg. Gender, Community, honesty…

(i) **Nominal data** are the outcome of classification into two or more categories of items or units comprising a sample or a population according to some quality characteristic. Classification of students according to their sex (as males and females), Workers according to their skill (as skilled, semi-skilled, and unskilled), and of employees according to their level of education (as matriculates, undergraduates, and post-graduates).

(ii) **Rank data,** on the other hand, are the result of assigning ranks to specify

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